

There are several ways to run a GitHub Actions workflow, depending on how it is configured.

Option 1: Run from the GitHub UI (Manual Trigger)

This works if your workflow includes:

</> YAML



```
on:
  workflow_dispatch:
```

Steps

1. Open your GitHub repository.
2. Click the **Actions** tab.
3. In the left pane, select your workflow (for example, **Playwright Tests**).
4. Click the **Run workflow** dropdown (top-right).
5. Select the branch (e.g., `main`).
6. Enter any required input parameters (such as `environment` or `suite`).
7. Click **Run workflow**.

Example:

Repository

└─ Actions

└─ Playwright Tests

└─ Run workflow ▼

Branch: main

Environment: qa

Suite: Smoke

[Run workflow]



Option 2: Trigger Automatically on Push

If your workflow contains:

</> YAML



```
on:
  push:
    branches:
      - main
```

Then simply:

</> Bash



```
git add .
git commit -m "Run Playwright"
git push origin main
```

GitHub will automatically start the workflow.

Option 3: Trigger on Pull Request

</> YAML



```
on:
  pull_request:
    branches:
      - main
```

Creating or updating a pull request targeting `main` will trigger the workflow.

Option 4: Trigger from Jenkins

If you have configured the API call as discussed earlier, Jenkins sends a request to GitHub:

</> Bash



```
curl -X POST \
-H "Authorization: Bearer <PAT>" \
https://api.github.com/repos/<owner>/<repo>/actions/workflows/playwright.yml/dispatches \
-d '{"ref": "main"}'
```

This starts the workflow without opening GitHub.

If You Don't See "Run workflow"

Check these items:

1. The workflow file is in the correct location

It must be:

```
.github/
  workflows/
```



playwright.yml

Not:

.github/playwright.yml
workflows/playwright.yml



2. The workflow includes `workflow_dispatch`

Example:

YAML



```
name: Playwright Tests

on:
  workflow_dispatch:
```

Without `workflow_dispatch`, the **Run workflow** button will not appear.

3. The workflow file is committed to the selected branch

For example:

Bash



```
git add .
git commit -m "Add workflow"
git push origin main
```

If the file only exists locally, GitHub cannot display or run it.

4. You have the required repository permissions

You need permission to run workflows (typically **Write** or **Maintain** access).

Example Workflow

YAML



```
name: Playwright Tests

on:
  workflow_dispatch:
    inputs:
      suite:
        description: Test Suite
        required: true
        default: Smoke

jobs:
  test:
    runs-on: ubuntu-latest

    steps:
      - uses: actions/checkout@v4

      - uses: actions/setup-node@v4
        with:
          node-version: 22

      - run: npm ci

      - run: npx playwright install --with-deps

      - run: npx playwright test --grep "@${{ github.event.inputs.suite }}"
```

Once this file is pushed to the repository, you'll find it under the **Actions** tab, where you can click **Run workflow** and provide the `suite` input.

If you're not seeing the **Run workflow** button, share your

`.github/workflows/playwright.yml` file, and I can help identify what's preventing it from appearing.